desperate as to be almost demented. After giving us details of the battle of Walong and warning us of the extreme gravity of the situation, Bijji pushed all circumspection aside and starkly asked for foreign military intervention to save the situation'. When the message was shown to Thapar, he said: 'Bijji has finally lost his mind. He expects us to invite the Americans to fight our battles! We'll have to show this to the PM.' Shortly after briefing Nehru on the situation in Walong and showing him Kaul's message, Thapar and Palit were airborne for Tezpur.

The defences at Hayuliang were subsequently strengthened but the Chinese only advanced up to a post on the high ground north of the town.